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JUDE AWAKENING

The latest El Clasico had all the ingredients of **top-tier drama**, as Real Madrid's Jude Bellingham had the last word with the match-winning goal.

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The El Clásico, as usual, had all eyes on it on matchday 10 of La Liga, and the contest was set up deliciously given the league positions. A Real Madrid win would have extended its lead at the top of the table, while a Barcelona victory would have allowed the Catalans to leapfrog their arch-rival.

In the season's first El Clasico, at the Santiago Bernabeu, Madrid had the last laugh as it beat Barca 2-1 to consolidate its lead at the top. Kylian Mbappe opened the scoring in the 22nd minute but Barcelona quickly responded courtesy of Fermin Lopez's goal in the 38th minute. Just before half-time, Jude Bellingham (**facing page**) found the net to restore Madrid's lead, and that proved enough as Los Blancos held on for the win.

The night turned worse for Barcelona after midfielder Pedri saw red late in stoppage time. As with every Clasico, tensions ran high and both camps were involved in a post-match scuffle, which led to Andriy Lunin (who was not on the pitch) also being shown a red card.

Real Madrid kept its winning momentum intact, beating Valencia 4-0 the following week, with Mbappe grabbing a brace and Bellingham and Alvaro Carreras scoring one each.

Barcelona returned to winning ways too, beating Elche 3-1. Lamine Yamal got on the scoresheet after a lacklustre showing in the Clasico, with Ferran Torres and Marcus Rashford also scoring.

The other Madrid giant, Atletico, also enjoyed a good gameweek, beating Sevilla 3-0.

At the end of matchday 11, Real (30) is top, with Barcelona (25), Villarreal (23), and Atletico (22) in second, third, and fourth.

Premier League

There was finally some light at the end of the tunnel for Liverpool as it ended its four-game losing streak in the Premier League after clinching a 2-0 win against Aston Villa. It was also a memorable evening for Mohamed Salah, who celebrated a personal landmark, with the Egyptian scoring his 250th goal for the Reds.

Manchester United's three-game winning streak in the league came to an end after a 2-2 draw against Nottingham Forest. After taking a 1-0 lead through Casemiro's goal, Ruben Amorim's side conceded twice in as many minutes, but it avoided defeat after Amad Diallo scored a well-taken equaliser in the 81st minute.

Chelsea, which had suffered a shock 2-1 defeat against Sunderland, bounced back to winning ways in the London Derby against Tottenham Hotspur, with Joao Pedro scoring the only goal of the contest.

Erling Haaland continued his supreme goalscoring form, finding the net twice in Manchester City's 3-1

win against Bournemouth. With 13 goals, the Norwegian comfortably leads the Premier League Golden Boot race.

It was business as usual for Arsenal, which, with every passing week, looks like the team most likely to finish top and win its first league title since the 2003-04 season. Mikel Arteta's side kept its winning run alive with a 2-0 victory against Burnley.

It was the end of the road for Wolverhampton Wanderers manager Vitor Pereira, who was sacked after the club's 0-3 loss against Fulham. With 10 matches played, Wolves are yet to win a game, currently sitting bottom of the table with just two points. At the end of matchday 10, Arsenal tops the standings with 25 points. Manchester City (19) is second, followed by Liverpool (18) and Bournemouth (18) in third and fourth. Tottenham, Chelsea, Sunderland (yet to play its matchday 10 fixture at the time of writing), and Manchester United are fifth, sixth, seventh, and eighth respectively, all on 17 points.

Serie A

Napoli asserted its authority as the reigning champion when it dispatched Italian giant Inter Milan 3-1 thanks to strikes from Kevin De Bruyne, Scott McTominay and André-Frank Zambo Anguissa. However, Antonio Conte's night was marred by a serious hamstring injury to De Bruyne, sustained while scoring the opening goal from the penalty spot. The Belgian has since